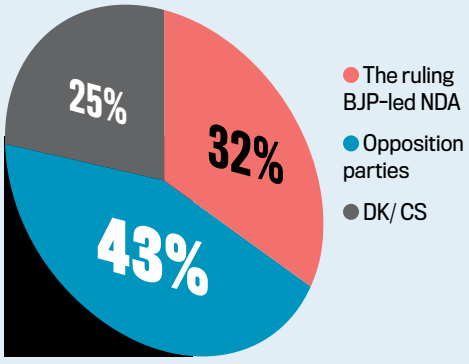
WHO AMONG THE CURRENT OPPOSITION LEADERS IS BEST SUITED TO LEAD THE OPPOSITION ALLIANCE?

	Jan. 2022	Aug. 2021	Jan. 2021
MAMATA BANERJEE	17%	17%	11%
ARVIND KEJRIWAL	16%	20%	18%
RAHUL GANDHI	11%		
AKHILESH YADAV	7%	8%	8%
SONIA GANDHI	10%		
SHARAD PAWAR	5%	6%	7%
MAYAWATI	2%	5%	6%
NAVEEN PATNAIK	1%	5%	5%
UDDHAV THACKERAY	3%		
JAGAN MOHAN REDDY	1%	5%	4%
M.K. STALIN	2%		
TEJASHWI YADAV	1%	3%	4%

Rest: Others

Q. WHO, ACCORDING TO YOU, IS RESPONSIBLE FOR THE FREQUENT DISRUPTIONS IN PARLIAMENT?



deputy chief minister of Rajasthan, who turned rebel in 2020, seeking to replace incumbent chief minister Ashok Gehlot. However, Pilot's stature as a Congress leader has diminished in the public eye, with his rating slipping from a personal high of 17 per cent in the previous MOTN.

The uncertainty about the party's leadership and its diminishing electoral footprint have encouraged other opposition parties, such as the TMC, to stake their claims as the fulcrum of the anti-BJP Opposition. Alliances are now being negotiated and forged without the Congress playing a key role. For instance, West Bengal chief minister and TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee has decided to campaign for Akhilesh Yadav's Samajwadi Party in the UP assembly election, due in February/March. There is apparent public support for such a push—nearly 48 per cent believe the TMC can build—and lead—an effective alliance of opposition parties. Bolstered by a comprehensive victory against the BJP in the West Bengal assembly election last year, Mamata Banerjee has emerged as the favourite among Opposition leaders to lead an alliance—with more than 17 per cent respondents backing her, up from 11 per cent exactly a year ago. In contrast, Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, who heads the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), has seen a drop in his acceptance as leader of an Opposition alliance—from 20 per cent six months ago to 15.5 per cent now. Not good news for him, considering his ambition to wield greater national influence, and his party's forays into other states such as Punjab, Gujarat, Uttarakhand and Goa.

53% 18 TO 24-YR-OLDS, AND 49% ACROSS ALL AGE GROUPS, **THINK AN OPPOSITION ALLIANCE TO CHALLENGE BJP** AT THE CENTRE IS POSSIBLE

Despite the swinging popularity ratings of individual leaders and the jockeying for influence among them, voters are hopeful of the formation of an effective alliance to challenge the Modi-led BJP at the Centre, with nearly 50 per cent respondents backing the idea. What's even more encouraging for the opposition parties is that the share of naysayers has decreased—from 43 per cent six months ago to 41 per cent now. Now for the harder task of these opposition leaders managing to get their act together, rise above personal ambitions, and justify the public trust. ■